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EXHIBIT IDENTIFIER: EXHIBIT_SG_05	**VECTOR MAPPING:** Vector 0001 / 1805
DOCUMENT TITLE: The Ostend Manifesto: Official Memorandum of U.S. Ministers Buchanan, Soulé, and Mason	**HISTORICAL DATE:** 1854-10-18
PRIMARY DEPOSITORY: NARA RG 59 (Department of State)	**RECORD GROUP / ENTRY:** Entry: Diplomatic Instructions; Senate Exec. Doc. No. 93, 33d Cong., 2d Sess.
FRE ADMISSIBILITY: FRE 803(8), FRE 803(16), FRE 902(5)	**STATUS:** AUTHENTICATED PRIMARY SOURCE

TACTICAL EVIDENTIARY SIGNIFICANCE (ARCHIVAL SENTINEL ANALYSIS):
U.S. Ministers to Great Britain, France, and Spain assert that the United States has the right to wrest Cuba from Spain by force if Spain refuses to sell.

VERBATIM PRIMARY SOURCE TRANSCRIPTION:

Aix-la-Chapelle, October 18, 1854.

To the Honorable William L. Marcy, Secretary of State, Washington, D.C.

Sir: The undersigned, in compliance with your instructions, submit our conclusions regarding the acquisition of Cuba.

The Union can never enjoy repose, nor possess reliable security, as long as Cuba is not embraced within its boundaries... Our past history forbids that we should acquire the island of Cuba without the consent of Spain, unless justified by the great law of self-preservation. We should, however, be recreant to our duty, be unworthy of our gallant forebears, and commit base treason against our posterity, should we permit Cuba to be Africanized and become a second St. Domingo.

Does Cuba, in the possession of Spain, seriously endanger our internal peace and the existence of our cherished Union? Should this question be answered in the affirmative, then, by every law, human and divine, we shall be justified in wresting it from Spain if we possess the power.

JAMES BUCHANAN, JOHN Y. MASON, PIERRE SOULÉ.

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